10–12 第1篇

阅读理解（议论文） Should Middle-School Students Be Encouraged to Write Handwritten Letters to Family Members?

① Last Saturday morning, my aunt in Guangzhou sent my mother a photograph on WeChat. In the photograph was a small grey envelope, written in careful pencil, with the words: "**To Auntie, from Leyu, age 12**". Inside, my cousin Leyu had written three short paragraphs about her new school, her pet hamster, and the autumn wind at the city park. My mother read the photograph quietly for a long time. Then she said, "We used to write letters like this every Sunday, when I was twelve. Nobody does it now."

② Her words set me thinking. In a world of instant messages, voice notes and video calls, **do we still need handwritten letters?** And should middle-school students be encouraged to write one every month to a family member? I believe the answer is a quiet but firm **yes**.

③ First, a handwritten letter forces **slow thinking**. A message on a phone is tapped in twenty seconds, sent, and forgotten. A letter requires you to sit down, pick up a pen, and shape every word with your hand. Your thoughts come out not in a stream of small bubbles but in a small paragraph. Many students find that the first draft of a letter is very poor — and that this poor first draft is exactly where real writing begins. Slow writing teaches students, gently, to think before they speak.

④ Second, a letter builds **a small archive of love**. Messages disappear. A letter stays. My grandmother still keeps a shoebox of my grandfather's letters from 1978, each one yellowed and folded in thirds. She says that on a hard day she takes one out and reads it. My mother's WeChat chats from 2021 are already gone — the old phone was thrown away. Photos fade, apps close, but a neat letter in a drawer can outlive the phone that might have carried it. A middle-school student who writes ten letters a year to his grandmother is, without knowing it, building her a small paper museum.

⑤ Third, a letter **protects handwriting itself**. A recent survey in three Chinese cities found that nearly 40 percent of Grade 9 students could not write more than two pages of clear, neat Chinese without aching hands. They can type fast, but their characters are slow, wobbly, and often forgotten. Writing a 300-character letter once a month is a simple, pleasant way to keep the muscles of writing alive. And neat writing, in Chinese or English, still matters — in exams, in job applications, in notes left on a kitchen table.

⑥ **Critics raise fair points**. One is **time**: middle-school students are already busy with homework, exams, clubs and sleep. Adding a monthly letter sounds like one more duty. But a **once-a-month** letter — say, on the first Sunday afternoon of each month — is, at most, thirty or forty minutes of calm writing, often pleasanter than another hour of maths. For many students, it becomes a welcome rest.

⑦ Another worry is **that the older family members will not reply**. True, grandma may not write back the same day, or at all. But the point is not equal exchange; it is giving. A grandmother who cannot write but can still read will likely keep that letter under her pillow for a week, and tell every neighbour about it. The silence after a letter is often fuller than a reply.

⑧ A third worry is **modern life**: if we have group chats, voice messages and video calls, why bother with paper? This is like asking why we still have family dinners when fast food exists. Each thing does something different. A WeChat message sends news; a letter sends **time** — the time you took to write it. The difference is felt, not measured.

⑨ There is also a deeper reason. A student who has, by graduation, written twenty careful letters to family members has quietly practised **three hard skills**: planning a thought, choosing the right word, and caring about someone who is not right in front of him. These are life skills no exam paper can fully test.

⑩ So my suggestion is simple. Let every middle-school student write **one handwritten letter a month** to a family member — a grandparent, a parent working far from home, an aunt, or even a younger brother. Schools can help by setting aside one home-reading period each month, or by providing simple paper and a stamp. Nobody is asking us to throw away our phones. We are only asking, once a month, to send a family member **something that can be held in the hand**.

注释： handwritten 手写的；archive 档案；wobbly 歪扭的；exchange 交换；hamster 仓鼠

根据文章内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What is the writer's main view?

A. Middle-school students should never send phone messages to family.
B. Middle-school students should be encouraged to write one handwritten letter a month to a family member.
C. Writing letters is a waste of time.
D. Only old people should write letters.

2. According to Paragraph 3, what does writing a letter by hand teach students?

A. To type as fast as possible.
B. To speak in short bubbles like phone messages.

C. To slow down and think carefully before writing, so that their first draft becomes the real beginning of writing.
D. To skip punctuation.

3. Why does the writer say a letter builds "a small archive of love" (Paragraph 4)?

A. Because letters can be sold later for money.
B. Because, unlike phone messages which disappear, a good letter kept in a drawer can outlive phones and apps, becoming a long-lasting paper record of family love.
C. Because letters smell nice.
D. Because only letters contain photos.

4. How does the writer reply to the worry that "older family members will not reply"?

A. He agrees and says letters are pointless.
B. He argues that the goal is not equal exchange but giving; even a grandmother who cannot write will cherish the letter and its silence is often fuller than a reply.
C. He says grandmothers should be forced to write back.
D. He says only older people should receive letters.

5. What does the writer mean by saying "a WeChat message sends news; a letter sends time" (Paragraph 8)?

A. Letters travel through time machines.
B. The real difference is that a message sends information, but a letter also sends the time and care the writer spent — something that cannot be typed quickly.
C. Letters are slower than the post.
D. Clocks should be written on every envelope.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】主旨/观点题
【定位】第②段 "a quiet but firm yes" 以及第⑩段 "Let every middle-school student write one handwritten letter a month"
【解析】作者明确主张"每月一封手写家书"。A、C、D 均偏离立场。故选 B。

2.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段 "Slow writing teaches students, gently, to think before they speak."
【解析】手写迫使学生慢下来、先思后写。A、B、D 均与原文相反。故选 C。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】词义猜测/推理题
【定位】第④段 "Messages disappear. A letter stays ... a neat letter in a drawer can outlive the phone that might have carried it."
【解析】"档案"是指持久性与情感积累。A、C、D 均误读。故选 B。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】推理判断题
【定位】第⑦段 "the point is not equal exchange; it is giving ... The silence after a letter is often fuller than a reply."
【解析】作者转变对"回信"的期待为"给予"本身。A 放弃、C、D 均偏离。故选 B。

5.
【答案】B
【题型】词义猜测/主旨辅助题
【定位】第⑧段 "a letter sends time — the time you took to write it. The difference is felt, not measured."
【解析】"送时间"喻指传递用心耗费的光阴。A、C、D 字面误解。故选 B。